

The Gazette Looking back

100 years ago — July 16, 1897

Mr. Jos Cullen, while cutting rye with a mowing machine the other day, accidentally cut the leg off his dog.

Farmers say that the late rains have metamorphosed the face of their farms. Everything has taken a new lease of life, and the blueness of last week has taken on a roseate hue. Hay will be light. Pressed hay is being brought in in some places, and is being retailed at \$14.

Albert Draper was up before Squire Smith last Friday night charged with using insulting language towards Caretaker Moulton, of the post office. He admitted the charge, and on getting the option of paying \$4 and costs (in all \$8.85) or thirty days in gaol at hard labor, took the days; but his friends afterward made up the fine, which amounted to a dollar a word for the objectionable language he had used — a lesson to all loose-tongued individuals.

50 years ago — July 17, 1947

Hydro was turned on in the Blakeney section on Wednesday. Those who had their buildings wired are also being served with electricity on the 10th line as far up as Mr. Bob McPhail's.

Some of the farmers had their wiring done two years ago but the scarcity of supplies prevented Hydro from completing their end of the work.

Following a teenage dance in the Orange Hall last Thursday night, it was decided to form a permanent organization with the object of furthering recreation. It was decided to call it "Club 21" which indicates the maximum age eligible for membership while the minimum was set at 13 years. The following rules were drawn up at the meeting:

No drinking or smoking to be allowed at any of the meetings.

Dancing must be over at 12 o'clock.

Membership cards — \$1, to be carried on the person for presentation at the meetings.

Rowdiness and bad language to be banned.

This is the first organization of this kind to be formed in town, so far as is known. It is hoped that it will provide the teen ageers with well regulated recreation, the responsibility for which will rest with the young folk themselves.

25 years ago — July 20, 1972

The Ontario Cabinet has approved regulations forbidding non-returnable polyethylene three quart milk containers of plastic coated paper, Environment Minister James Auld announced today.

He said Ontario's action on these containers is the first step in attacking the added load that disposable packaging places on waste disposal.

The world's only remaining Japanese "Val" Dive Bomber is scheduled to be officially presented to the Canadian Government at the 1972 Carp Air Show, a Festival Canada event on July 22, 1972.

Ten years ago — July 22, 1987

The Ramsay Township Arena and the Manctick Arena will be making some energy conservation improvements thanks to a grant totaling \$12,826 from the Ontario Ministry of Energy, under the Municipal Oil Conversion and Energy Conservation Program.

Lanark-Renfrew-Carleton MP Paul Dick makes no excuses about his Easter weekend stay in Paris which recently came under fire in the Ottawa Media.

The Ottawa Citizen reported that Mr. Dick had only two meetings to attend in Paris, but stayed for a long weekend. Mr. Dick said there were two more meetings arranged later and were not on the original itinerary, but do appear on the final one.

The Associate Defense Minister said he was negotiating a deal with a French business consortium which could result in an arms deal worth more than \$100 million.

He said the Ottawa paper "probably spent more money" researching the article than his entourage did on the Paris visit.

COLUMNS



Pic of the Past

This chilly shot of Grade 10 students was taken around noon hour in front of Almonte High School sometime in January, 1953. They are (left to right) Pauline McKay, Edith McCartney, Eleanor Cavanagh and Shirley Smith. Photo submitted by Pauline (McKay) Ferdinand.

Letters

From page 4

P.S. Antipersonnel mines kill 800 people and maim 1200 every single month — one victim every 20 minutes. World Vision's 30 Hour Famine will fund projects in Cambodia, Mozambique and Angola where children will be trained in mine-awareness.

Beautification efforts praised

To the editor:

The following letter was sent to Almonte BIA member Suzanne Charlebois

Dear Suzanne:

I would like to take this opportunity to congratulate you on what I would consider to be a "superb effort" in the beautification of downtown Almonte.

I was in town recently to meet with Philip Wood and as I walked up the street to his business I couldn't help but slow down and notice how attractive and welcoming the downtown looked. I immediately expressed my sentiments to Phil who indicated that you were largely responsible for the flowers.

Imagine how a traveller through Almonte would feel strolling down Mill Street. They too will want to slow down and spend more time.

Suzanne, your efforts are appreciated by residents and tourists alike!

Yours in Hospitality

Lanark County Economic Development Tourism Office
Marie Elmsley
Tourism Coordinator

Poetry Corner

Yesterday

How fragile is the landscape
How fleeting is the view
What yesterday was scenic land
Today has changed anew

The stump and log fence, long ago
Have vanished from the scene
That marked the boundaries of our homes
With fields of grain between

The pioneer cleared his land of stone
And piled it into mounds
'Long fence lines where the sod was rough
Beside his neighbours' bounds

Some fields they cleared are under crops
And some are forests new
While others form the basis for
A new town's avenue

Perhaps you've noted rows of stone
While travelling on your way
And wondered when and who did toil
In far-off yesterday

Each dawn that passes into night
Take history 'neath its wing
And 'morrow brings us different things
For memories to cling.

Lorne V. Parker

Some scenarios do not make sense

What's wrong with this picture?

A drunk driver kills two innocent people while out on bail. He completely ignores the conditions of his bail order. He racks up thousands and thousands of dollars in unpaid traffic fines. He has been charged again and again with driving while under the influence of alcohol.

The question begging to be asked: Why was he not kept in jail after the second offence when he was charged with impaired driving?

A father of a severely handicapped child decides to end her suffering and takes her life. She is grossly deformed and has a poor quality of life. He is charged with murder and sentenced, and is given a jail term.

A mother has a child with a mental disability. He is a beautiful young boy but hard to manage because of his disorder. He is not deformed or physically handicapped. She too, decides to end his life, and drowns him in a bathtub. The courts decide she was distraught and desperate and let her off. She will serve no time for the murder.

FROM THE HEART

By Mary Cook



The question begging to be asked: How do these two cases differ? Why did one murder earn a jail sentence and the other the sympathy of the judge?

A couple has worked hard all their lives to make a decent living and planned for their old age and retirement. They have accumulated a modest estate through their efforts and own their own home. They pass on before their home is sold and their estate used up. They have already paid ample taxes over the years. Their earnings now form a part of their estate. When they died, their children paid taxes again on what their parents have already paid taxes during their lifetime. It's called estate taxes...a better name

would be a tax grab by the government.

The question begging to be asked: How many times should a government be allowed to tax the same earnings?

For years you have paid insurance. Your house and contents are insured against everything from theft to loss by fire. Your car insurance payment is staggering. But the only way you can protect yourself and your property from disaster is to insure against the likelihood of its happening to you.

Then one day you either have an accident, someone breaks into your house and robs you of all your valuables, or your house burns to the

ground.

Your insurance company covers all your losses without complaint. The surprise comes when you get your next premium and you discover the costs have gone through the roof. If you're lucky you won't have another claim, because one of two things could happen. Your rates will skyrocket, or the company might decide they don't want you anymore as a client.

The questions begging to be asked: What is insurance for, if not to protect you from loss? If your loss is through no fault of yours, how can the insurance company justify either cancelling your policy or raising your rates? Why isn't the government, who is so quick to control every other aspect of our lives, not doing something about this gouging by the insurance companies. And by the way, don't take your frustrations out on your agent. He has nothing to do with what his company decides to do. He is only following their orders.

Anyone got any answers? I'd be glad to hear them.

Colourful birds make an appearance

Pileated woodpeckers are always exciting birds to spot but last week, Steve Moore found a whole family of four pileateds on Beckwith 9th line. Pileated woodpeckers make their nests in holes in trees and lay three to five eggs. After about twenty-five days, the young emerge almost the same size as the parents and follow them about as both parents feed them.

In the category of mystery bird this past week, Lorraine Leblanc in Clayton, reported a brownish streaked bird about the size of a finch which had a set of small white antenna like the horned larks. It stayed about the feeders for a week before disappearing. A check of my reference books did not produce an identity of this one. Any guesses?

Wetlands remain important features of Beckwith Township's environmental integrity. One such wetland is on the property of Harold and Daphne Marsten. Their wetland bird list is exceptional and includes Virginia and Sora rails, yellowthroat warblers, swamp sparrows, great crested and least flycatchers along with wood pewees and winter wrens. Lynda Bennett and Georgina Doe joined Daphne on Wednesday for a walk to the swamp and found a total of twenty-eight species.

Kay Carroll in Almonte, watched with interest a killdeer chasing away

a squirrel from her two baby birds and putting on the broken-wing act. Killdeer chicks are born precocious and take off with mother within three hours of birth. They have long legs and just a bit of fluff for feathers and soon learn to pick up bits of food on their own.

The small grouping of large white domestic geese plying the Mississippi River below Carleton Place, have been joined by a single Canada goose. As David Lloyd observed while on the nature trail, the white guys don't really take well to their intruder. John Bushby also reported this ensemble.

Eda Handfield-Jones, on Ramsay's 6th line, had plenty of colour around her feeders recently. Indigo buntings, rose-breasted and evening grosbeaks, blue jays, mourning doves, cardinals, purple finches and cowbirds, have put on quite a show of colour.

A rather wet golf game last Wednesday, left Art Dodge with a pair of

wet shoes. Leaving them on the verandah to dry, Art was surprised to discover a male rose-breasted grosbeak squatted down into the shoe as if he was about to build a nest. As Art loves his game of golf, he told the bird to get lost.

Bob Dennis reported his whip-poor-wills are back on the 10th line of Beckwith and he also watched a pair of brown thrashers down on his lawn picking about for bugs. Thrashers spend most of their time shyly plying the hedgerows of the country-side and this pair weren't too far from the nearest hedgerow.

Some birds do the darndest things. Mrs. Albert Willey on Church Street, watch a mourning dove lay an egg on a bare fence railing. There was no nest. Soon a squirrel came along and knocked the egg off, breaking it apart. The dove did not return to try it again.

Ursula Beddoes, Appleton, found a baby robin 10 days ago and nursed it to young adulthood. Its looking



STRICTLY FOR THE BIRDS

By Cliff Bennett 256-5013

quite lively now and heads out onto the lawn to feed itself. It always comes back to its new mom to get tucked away for the night. Ursula's son Hamish calls the bird "popcorn".

I always thought the bittern was the only bird that froze with its beak straight upward, looking like a brown reed stock. On Saturday, Ian Henderson was walking along the trail of his Ramsay woods when he came upon a male ruffed grouse. Instead of rushing into the thick tangle, the bird fluffed out its head feathers and poked its beak upward into the sky to look like a stick. It must have had its young nearby and wanted to protect them.

The majority of bird calls these days ends up on my answering machine for I am often away or on another call. Sometimes, a call is placed by someone with a difficult name which I try to spell correctly. When in doubt, I check the phone book, for everyone seems to leave their phone number.

However, there is always one or two names each week which are not clear enough to spell and are not in the phone book. I would appreciate clear pronunciation or even a spelling of difficult names so that I don't miss anyone or make mistakes. No one wants to have their name misrepresented.

For all your hometown news and sports, read The Almonte Gazette